THE BULLOCK PRESIDENCY

Series Bible — Document 07: The 2024 Congressional Elections

Verdict: critically important. After the presidential race, the battle for Congress on **Tuesday, November 5, 2024** is the most consequential election in the story. It decides *how* President Bullock achieves his first-term agenda. Under canon he succeeds 100%, but the makeup of Congress decides what each win costs and who he has to win over.

1. What's on the Ballot

- **All 435 House seats.** In real life, Republicans held the House 220–215.
- **34 Senate seats** (33 regular seats plus a special election in Nebraska). The real-world map was brutal for Democrats, who defended 23 seats, including Montana, Ohio, and West Virginia, in states Trump won. In real life Republicans flipped the Senate to 53–47.
- **State legislatures** in most states. They matter for ratifying the 28th Amendment (see Section 2).
- **Our timeline:** the presidential race is different (Marc is running), so the congressional results can be different too. Coattails are real.

2. Why It Matters So Much in Our Story

Stake	Why Congress decides it
The age-35 fallback (the biggest stake)	Until the 38th state ratifies on Dec 17, 2024, the country doesn't know whether Marc and Amond will be eligible. If ratification failed, the Speaker of the House chosen by the new 119th Congress (Jan 3, 2025) would become Acting President on Jan 20, 2025. **The House election literally decides who would be President in the worst case.** Republicans hold it: the GOP Speaker (in real life, Mike Johnson, Speaker since Oct 25, 2023). Democrats take it: Hakeem Jeffries. Every House race becomes a referendum on that question.
Universal Healthcare	A filibuster can block it in the Senate (60 votes needed). Alternative path: budget reconciliation (51 votes) for the funding pieces.
Universal Education	Needs appropriations from both chambers.
Eliminating the national debt and taxes	Tax law must start in the House (the Origination Clause). The income tax doesn't need a constitutional amendment to eliminate: the 16th Amendment *allows* an income tax but doesn't *require* one, so Congress can set it to zero. New national revenue sources need legislation.
Open borders	Requires rewriting the Immigration and Nationality Act, the hardest vote in Congress. Filibuster territory.
The North American Union	Either a **treaty** (two-thirds of the Senate, 67 votes) or a **congressional-executive agreement** (simple majorities in both chambers, the route NAFTA and the USMCA took).
The Cabinet and courts	The Senate confirms Arianna Cummings as Attorney General (51 votes, a hearing war), the rest of the Cabinet, and every federal judge and Supreme Court justice. Elxa (Chief of Staff) and Grace (Press Secretary) need no confirmation.
Oversight and investigations	A hostile House means subpoenas, hearings, possible impeachment attempts, and investigations into Donohue Entertainment conflicts. Cornelius would love that.
The 2032 wartime amendment	The 29th Amendment will need two-thirds of a later Congress. The coalitions Marc builds in 2025 are the ones he'll need in 2032.

3. Real-World 2024 Senate Battlegrounds (baseline)

These are the real 2024 races. Marc's candidacy changes the national environment, and possibly some of the candidates.

State	Real-world matchup	Real result
Montana	Jon Tester (D) vs. Tim Sheehy (R)	R flip
Ohio	Sherrod Brown (D) vs. Bernie Moreno (R)	R flip
Pennsylvania	Bob Casey (D) vs. Dave McCormick (R)	R flip
West Virginia	Open (Manchin retiring): Jim Justice (R)	R flip
Michigan	Open: Elissa Slotkin (D) vs. Mike Rogers (R)	D hold
Wisconsin	Tammy Baldwin (D) vs. Eric Hovde (R)	D hold
Arizona	Open (Sinema retiring): Ruben Gallego (D) vs. Kari Lake (R)	D gain
Nevada	Jacky Rosen (D) vs. Sam Brown (R)	D hold
Texas	Ted Cruz (R) vs. Colin Allred (D)	R hold
Florida	Rick Scott (R) vs. Debbie Mucarsel-Powell (D)	R hold
Nebraska	Deb Fischer (R) vs. Dan Osborn (I)	R hold
Maryland	Open: Angela Alsobrooks (D) vs. Larry Hogan (R)	D hold

4. Outcome Options for Our Story

Option	House	Senate	What it means for the story
A. Bullock wave, bipartisan governing (recommended)	D about 238–197	D 52–48 (holds MT, OH, PA; flips TX; loses WV)	A Democratic trifecta, but well short of 60 Senate votes. Every big win needs Republican votes, which is exactly Marc's bipartisan brand. Tyler Chapman, Simone Smilley, and Republican senators become key players. It makes the 100% success believable and dramatic.
B. Supermajority landslide	D 270+	D 60+	Nothing can stop him, so there is little legislative drama. It risks feeling like opponents are nerfed.
C. Divided government	R House	D or R Senate	Every win is a brutal fight. Investigations from day one. Maximum drama, but it's hard to make 100% success believable without huge cross-party deals.
D. Real-world results	R 220–215	R 53–47	A Republican trifecta against him. The hardest version, with the most 'Marc Move' rule-bending.

Recommendation (approved as a story thread): Option A. The coattails are real but not unlimited: a clear Democratic House (so Jeffries is the Speaker in the fail-safe scenario, which reassures the country), and a 52–48 Senate that forces bipartisanship. Marc's 100% success then comes from **building cross-party coalitions bill by bill**, which fits a "Democrat with Republican values" who believes in bipartisanship. The opposition stays strong, smart, and organized, and no one is nerfed.

STATUS: Story Thread (Not Locked)

Option A is the author-approved direction, not a predetermined result. The congressional outcome is a **living story thread**. It plays out on-page through 2023–2024 and can shift as events unfold. Nothing about the House or Senate results is fixed until the story reaches Election Night, Tue Nov 5, 2024.

- **The target:** a Democratic House (about 238–197) and a 52–48 Democratic Senate, which forces bipartisanship.
- **How it's earned:** candidate recruitment, retirements, primaries, Marc's endorsements and rallies, fundraising, scandals, debates, the Smilley Machine's choices in Georgia, and the opposition's counter-moves. Each is a beat the story has to earn.
- **It can change:** if the story's events point somewhere else (a lost race, a surprise flip, a party switch), the outcome follows the story, not the plan.

- **Threads to seed in 2023:** which senators retire, Democrats' Senate recruitment in Texas and Montana, whether Marc campaigns for down-ballot candidates, Cornelius's influence over Georgia and Southern races, Wes Thornton's GOP Senate strategy, and Tyler Chapman's Republican connections.
- **Ledger rule:** each race's status is tracked in the Canon Ledger as the story advances (open, leaning, called).

5. Key Congressional Dates

Date	Event
Mon Jul 1, 2024	The 118th Congress passes the 28th Amendment by two-thirds of both chambers.
Tue Nov 5, 2024	Election Day: President, all 435 House seats, 34 Senate seats.
Tue Dec 17, 2024	The 38th state ratifies the 28th Amendment. The Electoral College votes.
Fri Jan 3, 2025	The 119th Congress convenes and the Speaker is elected.
Mon Jan 6, 2025	Congress counts the electoral votes, with Vice President Kamala Harris presiding as President of the Senate.
Mon Jan 20, 2025	Inauguration. Confirmation hearings for the Cabinet begin.
Tue Nov 3, 2026	The midterms. The President's party historically loses seats. Can Marc defy history?